Nadav Kunievsky, Ph.D.

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University of Chicago–trained economist working at the frontier of AI and labor markets, combining causal inference and large language models to measure how technology reshapes work, knowledge, and decision-making.

Employment

Researcher, Knowledge Lab, University of Chicago (2026–present)
Senior Data Scientist, Upwork (2026–present)
Postdoctoral Researcher, Knowledge Lab, University of Chicago (2024–2026)
Under supervision of Prof. James A. Evans

Research Interests

AI; Large Language Models; Labor Economics; Causal Inference

Education

Ph.D. in Economics, University of Chicago, 2018–2024
Dissertation: *Essays in Labor Economics*
M.A. Economics, joint Tel Aviv University–Hebrew University program, 2014–2017 (Magna Cum Laude)
B.A. Economics and Accounting, Tel Aviv University, 2011–2014 (Magna Cum Laude)

Scholarships and Grants

- SISRM research-assistant funding ($10,000), 2025
- Becker-Friedman Institute Research Grant ($10,000), 2022
- Neubauer Fellowship and Theodore W. Schultz Fellowship Award, 2018–2023
- Scholarships for Outstanding Academic Achievements, Tel Aviv University, 2014–2017

Teaching

- TA, Job Mobility/Wage Determinants (Graduate), 2021
- TA, Honors Metrics (Undergraduate), 2021
- TA, Human Capital and Markets (Graduate), 2021
- TA, Empirical Analysis III (Graduate), 2020
- TA, Economics for Everyone (Undergraduate), 2020

Work in Progress

- "Quantifying Uncertainty over the Lifecycle"
- "Integrating Minority Perspectives: An Analysis of Women's Induction into the Field of Economics"
- "Can Complementarity Explain Path Dependence in Innovation? Evidence from the Secondary Market of Patents"

Publications

- "Measuring Intent Comprehension in LLMs," with James Evans, *Proceedings of the 43rd International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML)*, PMLR 306:61756–61805, 2026
- "On the Interpretation of the Intergenerational Elasticity and the Rank–Rank Coefficients for Cross Country Comparison," *Economics Letters* 236:111581, 2024
- "The High-Tech Sector," with Neil Gandal and Stefania Roccas Gandal, in *The Israeli Economy, 1995–2017: Light and Shadow in a Market Economy*, ch. 17, pp. 527–554 (Cambridge University Press), 2021
- "Network-Mediated Knowledge Spillovers in ICT/Information Security," with Neil Gandal and Lee Branstetter, *Review of Network Economics* 19(2):85–114, 2020. Related working paper: NBER No. 23808, 2017

Working Papers

- "PreScience: A Dataset and Benchmark for Scientific Forecasting," with A. Ajith, A. Singh, J. DeYoung, A. C. Kozlowski, O. Tafjord, et al., 2026
- "Measuring Behavior Portability in Large Language Models," with T. Dong and James A. Evans, 2026
- "U.S. Technological Containment and the Rise of China's Open AI Ecosystem," with W. Jin, B. Lou, T. Sun, and James Evans, 2026
- "The Effect of Age at Arrival on the Alignment Between Immigrant and Native-Born Gender Norms: A Distributional Approach," 2026
- "Content vs. Form: What Drives the Writing Score Gap Across Socioeconomic Backgrounds? A Generated Panel Approach," with P. Pertusi, 2026
- "Biased AI Improves Human Performance but Reduces Perceived Helpfulness," with S. Lai, J. Choi, J. Kim, Y. Potter, and James Evans, 2025. Earlier version presented at the *NeurIPS 2025 Workshop on Algorithmic Collective Action*
- "Linear Regression in a Nonlinear World," 2025
- "Polarization by Design: How Elites Could Shape Mass Preferences as AI Reduces Persuasion Costs," 2025
- "The (Short-Term) Effects of Large Language Models on Unemployment and Earnings," with D. Chen, C. Kane, A. C. Kozlowski, and James A. Evans, 2025
- "Missing vs. Unused Knowledge Hypothesis for Language Model Bottlenecks in Patent Understanding," with S. Wu, H. Bao, and James A. Evans, 2025
- "Bridging the Gap: Information, Returns and Choices," 2024
- "It's Not Who You Are, It's What They Know: Wage Gaps and Informational Frictions," 2024
- "Uncovering Latent Types in Sequential Choice Data Using Text Embedding Algorithm," 2024